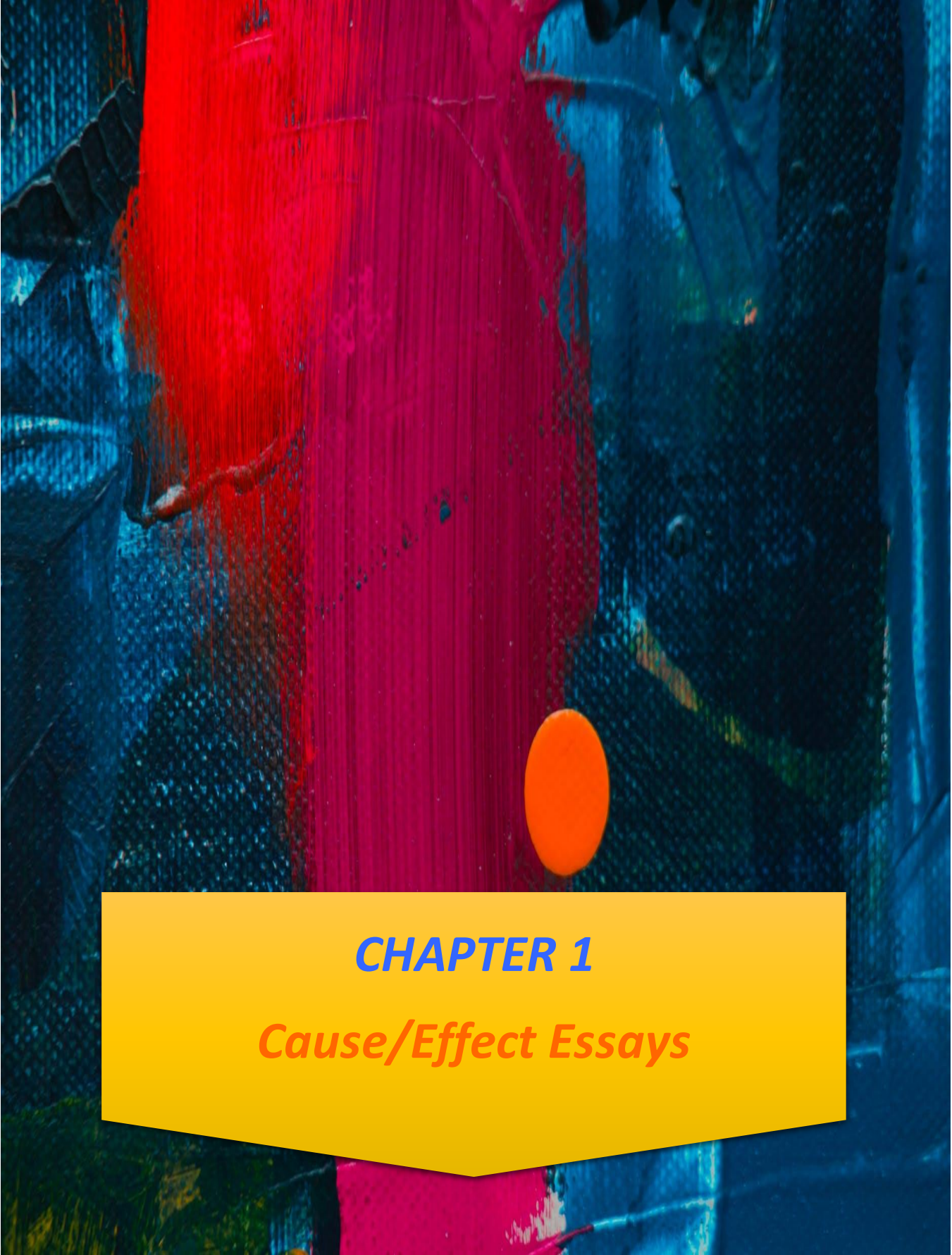




CHAPTER 1

Cause/Effect Essays

1. INTRODUCTION TO CAUSE/EFFECT ESSAY

Why is it important to learn the cause/effect genre?

In academic writing, you will frequently need to use cause/effect organization when expressing your opinion and explaining a situation.

For example:

- In a sociology class, you might be asked to analyze **the effects of** the Second World War on the liberation of women in society.
- In a psychology class, you might be asked to analyze **the reasons why** hypnosis is not recommended for some people.
- In an economics class, you might be asked to explain **the effects of** comparative advantage theory.

To be able to analyze the causes or effects of a situation, you need to determine the reasons and the results and use some particular sentence patterns.

1.2. WHAT IS A CAUSE/EFFECT ESSAY?

- Cause and effect essays are concerned with **why** things happen (causes) and **what** happens as a result (effects).
- Topics always have a number of possible causes and effects.
 - To determine **CAUSES**, ask "WHY DID THIS HAPPEN?"
 - To determine **EFFECTS**, ask "WHAT HAPPENED BECAUSE OF THIS?"

a. The following is a simple example of one cause producing one effect:



b. Sometimes, many causes contribute to a single effect or many effects may result from a single cause.

What are the causes of/reasons for choosing to major in accounting department?	• liked business in high school • salaries in the field are high • have an aunt who is an accountant • good with numbers
What are the effects of reduced work hours?	• employer is irritated • more time to study • more time for family and friends

Read the writing prompts below. In groups, try to come up with as many reasons/results as you can to answer the questions. You will present your reasons and results to the rest of the class.

1. What are the reasons for learning a second language?
2. Why do people have mobile phones?
3. Why do we feel so stressed, even though we have so much technology?
4. What are the effects of being a workaholic?
5. What are the consequences of having a big family?
6. How does global warming affect people's lives?
7. What are the positive effects of reading books?

1.3. BRAINSTORMING AND MAKING AN OUTLINE

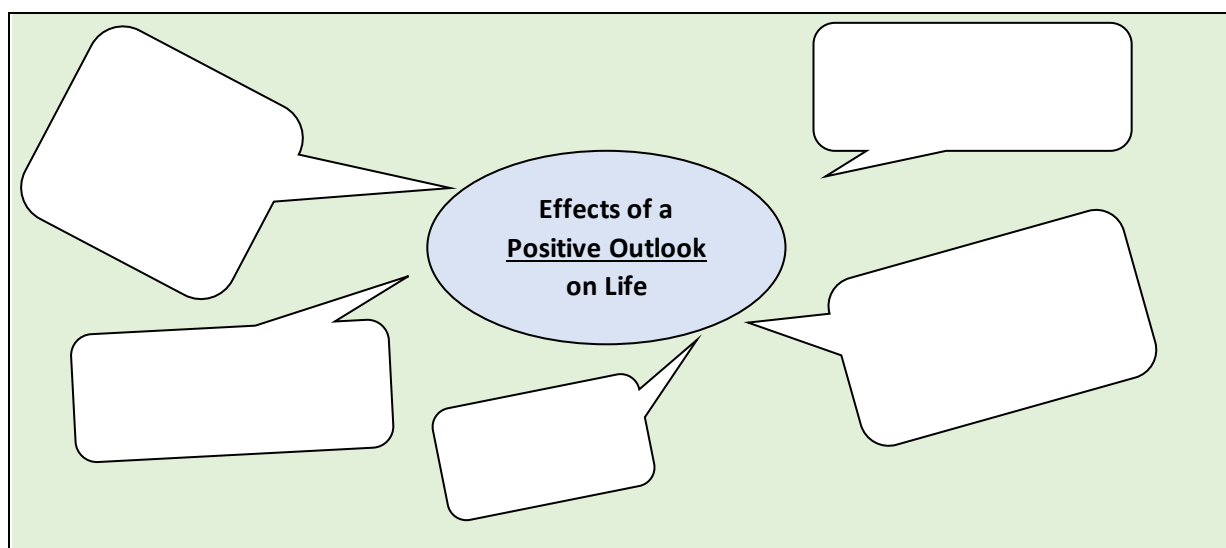
Exercise

Warm-up Questions

1. Do you know anyone who has a positive outlook on life? Which six adjectives would you use to describe this person? Can you give an example about a challenging situation that she handled by being positive?
2. How do you think it would affect your life if you had a more positive outlook on life?

A) Brainstorming

To generate ideas, brainstorming is a great tool. The picture below shows one way to brainstorm, using 'balloons'. The topic is put in the center of the page and all the connected ideas go around in any order. The best way is to time yourself – for example, five minutes – and to write as many ideas that come to mind and write them as fast as you can in that time. When you finish, try to organize your ideas and make some connections. Start with the most general idea and link them to the details and the examples that you thought about.



B) Read the paragraphs A - D below for the essay *"The Effects of a Positive Outlook on Our Lives"*. The paragraphs are not in the correct order. Working with a partner, number the paragraphs 1 to 4 in the best order.

The Effects of a Positive Outlook on Our Lives



..... (A) People with a positive outlook are stronger and more capable of confronting difficult situations. They develop clear minds, which help them cope with life's challenges better than those individuals who are not at peace with themselves. Happy people's optimism creates the strength needed to find rational solutions to the many unexpected problems that life presents. Another reason why they can easily handle challenges is this optimism also promotes their self-confidence and self-esteem. For example, happier students are more likely to approach professors for help when they are having some trouble with their course work. They also do not hesitate to take risks since they believe in their potential and they are not afraid of making mistakes. In contrast, unhappy or less happy students may internalize their frustration and be less likely to seek out help.

..... (B) In conclusion, happiness will bring us strong relationships, the ability to face any obstacle and the opportunity to achieve our goals. It is a good idea to have a positive outlook and recognize what makes us happy since it will bring us more harmony. If we promise ourselves to laugh more and think positively, we will change our lives for the better.

..... (C) Happiness is a state of being that everyone wants to achieve. There are many different ways of becoming a happy person. A positive outlook, which is one of the many ways of reaching a state of happiness, can help you be happy and change the outcome of your life. A positive outlook can enrich your relationships and guide you through some of life's greatest challenges.

..... (D) A positive outlook helps you find happiness in professional and social relationships. Having a positive attitude will help you find a good job and keep it. Colleagues enjoy working with someone who always looks on the bright side and avoids conflict. Your positive attitude towards your work and colleagues will enhance your relationships with them. Another benefit of approaching your relationships positively is that friends will appreciate your energy and want to spend more time with you. A happy person makes everybody else happy as happiness is contagious. As a consequence, any partnership will be a solid, strong and happy relationship with the help of a positive outlook.

C) Now with your partner, complete the outline below for the same essay.

I. INTRODUCTION:

Thesis Statement: *A positive outlook can enrich your relationships, guide you through some of life's greatest challenges and help you achieve your goals.*

II. BODY PARAGRAPH 1:

Topic Sentence: _____

Support 1: _____

Support 2: *It also has a beneficial effect on social relationships.*

III. BODY PARAGRAPH 2:

Topic Sentence: *People with a positive outlook are stronger and capable of confronting difficult situations.*

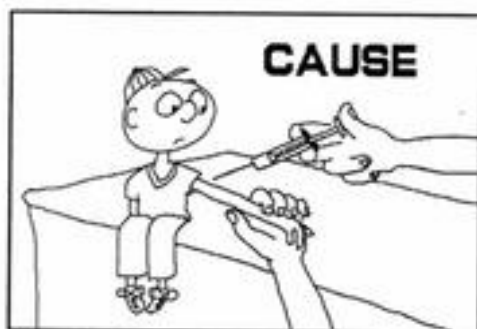
Support 1: _____

Support 2: _____

IV. CONCLUSION:

Paraphrasing the Thesis Statement: *In conclusion, happiness will bring us strong relationships, the ability to face any obstacle and the opportunity to achieve their goals.*

Final comment: _____



2. WRITING CAUSE/EFFECT ESSAYS

2.1. INTRODUCTION PARAGRAPH

The introductory paragraph is the first paragraph in an essay.

What is the purpose of the introduction paragraph?

- ✓ **To capture the reader's attention.**
- ✓ **To introduce the topic of your essay and give background information.**
- ✓ **To state the main idea of your essay (thesis statement).**

A) CAPTURING THE READER'S ATTENTION

The best way to capture the reader's attention is to start your essay with a **HOOK**.



A hook is an interesting sentence or a group of sentences or phrases that grab the reader's attention. The purpose of a hook is to create curiosity and keep your reader interested so that he/she keeps reading your essay.

The hook usually appears in the first sentence or first couple of sentences in your introductory paragraph.

Different types of hooks:

1. Question
2. Quotation
3. Facts and Statistics
4. General Statement

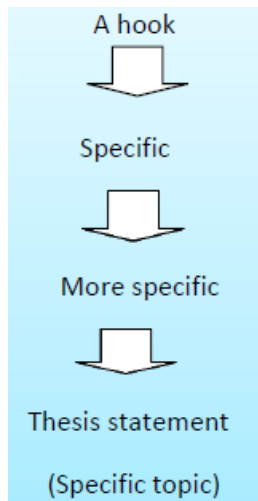
Example Hook Statements:

1. Question: Isn't it unfortunate that in today's society there are so many people who cannot read, write or even do arithmetic?
2. Quotation: As Benjamin Franklin very nicely pointed out, "Genius without education is like silver in the mine."
3. Facts and Statistics: According to the Ministry of Education, since 2003 the budget for higher education has increased steadily. In 2003, it was 9 percent. By 2009, it rose to 14 percent.
4. General Statement: Happiness is a state of being that everyone wants to achieve.

B) GIVING BACKGROUND INFORMATION

After you write your **hook**, you need to **narrow down** your general topic to a more specific one and move towards the **thesis statement**. Here, you inform the reader about your topic by using a few methods;

✓ The Funnel Approach



This approach provides a smooth transition from something general to a specific thesis. This is the most used way of writing introduction paragraphs.

✓ Writing the definition of important terminology

This method, which also follows the funnel approach, is best when the topic is technical or when not everyone knows about it, such as euthanasia, nuclear energy, Alzheimer's disease, etc.

Example: *"Do you know that 44 of the world's states are monarchies? A monarchy is a kind of government where a monarch, a kind of hereditary ruler (someone who inherits their office), is the head of state."*

✓ Reverse Cause and Effect

This is an effective introduction writing method to explain underlying **reasons** in an **effect** essay and overall **results** in a **cause** essay. In other words, you **CANNOT** mention any **specific causes before the thesis statement in a cause essay**, and you **CANNOT** mention any **specific effects before the thesis statement in an effect essay**.

Example 1

What are the effects of migration?

Overpopulation in cities is a phenomenon affecting many countries in the world. It is largely caused by the migration of people searching for new opportunities that rural areas cannot provide. They hope to find better employment opportunities, better health services and schooling in metropolitan areas. Though there exist some benefits in having large concentrations of people in an urban area, there are many negative outcomes. Two such outcomes of overpopulated cities are an increase in both health problems and crime rates.

Example 2

What are the causes of migration?

The movement from one part of the world to another is a fact of life for many people. This is called migration and it has had many effects on the world, culture and ideas spread, wars start and in some cases new nations are created. There are many reasons why people choose to leave their homes for new places. The two causes of migration discussed in this essay are war and employment opportunities.

Exercise

Read the following sample introductions and identify the prompt and the method or methods (funnel approach – from general to specific details, defining important words, or reverse cause and effect) used in each one.

1. Cancer is a leading cause of death worldwide. It kills more people in one year than all criminal and accidental deaths combined. Even though most people overcome the disease, they have to take on an immense financial burden to pay their hospital fees. Additionally, they have to struggle with physical side effects as well as emotional distress. Research shows different types of cancer might be caused by different factors, yet the main causes can be divided into environment and genetics.

Prompt: _____

Method(s): _____

2. Any person who has lived in the twentieth century has seen a lot of changes take place in almost all areas of human existence. Some people are excited by the challenges that these changes offer. However, those who consider the negative effects of these changes want to return to the simpler lifestyle of the past. The two undesirable effects of the changes brought by the twentieth century are a polluted environment and the depersonalization of human relationships.

Prompt: _____

Method(s): _____

Sample Thesis Statements for Cause Essays – GLOBALIZATION

Prompt: *What are the **causes** of globalization?*

- **The two causes of** globalization **are** developments in technology **and** capitalism.
- The developments in technology **and** capitalism **are two of the causes of** globalization.
- Globalization **stems from two major causes:** developments in technology **and** capitalism.
- Globalization **is caused by a number of factors, which include** developments in technology **and** capitalism.
- **The fact that** technology and capitalism have both developed in the last two centuries **has resulted in** globalization.

Sample Thesis Statements for Effect Essays – GLOBALIZATION

Prompt: *What are the **effects** of globalization?*

- Globalization **has two significant negative effects:** the destruction of local cultures **and** the standardization of lifestyles everywhere.
- **Because of** globalization, local cultures have been destroyed and lifestyles have become standard all around the world.
- **Two of the results of** globalization **are** the destruction of local cultures **and** the standardization of lifestyles.
- Globalization **has resulted in** the destruction of local cultures **and** the standardization of lifestyles.
- **Owing to the fact that** the world has become increasingly globalized, local cultures have been destroyed and lifestyles have become more or less standard.



Exercise

With a partner, choose one of the topics below and write an introductory paragraph. Remember to first **brainstorm** your ideas. Make sure that you use a **hook** to grab your reader's attention. Then continue with **general statements**, narrowing down your idea to your **thesis statement**.

Essay Topics:

1. What are the reasons for learning a second language?
2. Why do people have mobile phones?
3. Why do we feel more stressed than our parents' generation?
4. What are the effects of being a workaholic?
5. What are the consequences of having a big family?
6. How does global warming affect people's lives?
7. Why should people read books?

Brainstorming:

Topic:

Thesis Statement:

Introductory Paragraph:

2.2. WRITING A CONCLUSION PARAGRAPH

The last paragraph of your essay is the concluding paragraph. A concluding paragraph consists of:

- ✓ a restatement of the thesis statement
- ✓ a summary of the main points in the essay (OPTIONAL)
- ✓ a final comment on your topic

When you write your final comment, you can say:

In my opinion

It seems to me that

It is my firm belief that

To my mind

I think that

To my way of thinking

SAMPLE INTRODUCTION:

Air pollution can be defined as the contamination of air by the discharge of harmful substances. Modernization and progress have led to air getting more and more polluted over the years. Industries, vehicles, increase in the population, and urbanization are some of the major factors responsible for *air pollution, which results in several negative effects in terms of health and economy.*

SAMPLE CONCLUSION:

Taking everything into consideration, the two adverse effects of air pollution are diseases and economic issues stemming from it. Air pollution poses a threat to not only people's health but also to their money. In my view, both governments and individuals should take action to prevent this problem from getting more serious.

Now, write a conclusion paragraph for the topic you have chosen in the previous introduction writing exercise.

2.3. WRITING BODY PARAGRAPHS FOR CAUSE/EFFECT ESSAYS

After writing a good thesis statement, one of the challenges in essay writing is finding good and strong ideas to support the thesis statement. Without sufficient support your essay will not be convincing. Each body paragraph should be **well organized, developed**, and should have **coherence** and **unity**.

1. **Organization:** Each body paragraph should start with a **topic sentence** that states the main idea of the paragraph and has **supporting details** related to the topic sentence. All the sentences should follow a logical pattern.

Body paragraph 1 Topic sentence Supporting idea 1 Supporting idea 2 Concluding sentence	The first and most important cause/effect is..... Firstly / First of all/ To begin with,..... Moreover / In addition to this/ Besides, In short / Briefly,
Body paragraph 2 Topic sentence Supporting idea 1 Supporting idea 2 Concluding sentence	Another significant cause/ effect of..... Firstly / First of all /To begin with,..... Moreover / In addition to this / Besides, In short / Briefly,

Exercise

Now go over the outline to see how the ideas are organized, and compare it with the finalized body paragraph.

THESIS STATEMENT: There are two main factors that lead to poor health: stress and bad eating habits.

OUTLINE:

1. TOPIC SENTENCE: One of the most important reasons for poor health is stress.
2. SUPPORTING IDEA 1: larger and more crowded work places a. More people living and working together → more arguments, disagreements b. Stress in turn leads to poor health
3. SUPPORTING IDEA 2: financial problems a. Being unemployed + not earning enough money → not supporting families b. Losing hope and stop caring about their health

WHAT ARE THE FACTORS THAT LEAD TO POOR HEALTH?

BODY PARAGRAPH:

One of the most important reasons for poor health is stress. Firstly, one cannot deny that in the 21st century, work places are larger and more crowded. More specifically, there are more people working and living together than in the past. When a lot of people work together, there are always disagreements and arguments. As a consequence, all these problems will eventually cause stress which in turn leads to poor health. What is more, financial problems inevitably increase stress levels. Sometimes people are unemployed or do not earn enough money to support their families given the economic circumstances of the country. As a result, they lose their hope and stop caring about their health since finding a new job and maintaining their life are their only concerns.

Exercise

Read the thesis statements and write topic sentences for body paragraphs.

1. Global warming is caused by two major factors: man-made factors and natural factors.

a. _____

b. _____

2. Some women delay having children since they want to accomplish career objectives and do not want to limit themselves in their social lives.

a. _____

b. _____

2. Development (Writing Supporting Sentences)

The paragraph should provide a sufficient number of details: facts, statistics, examples, reasons, etc.

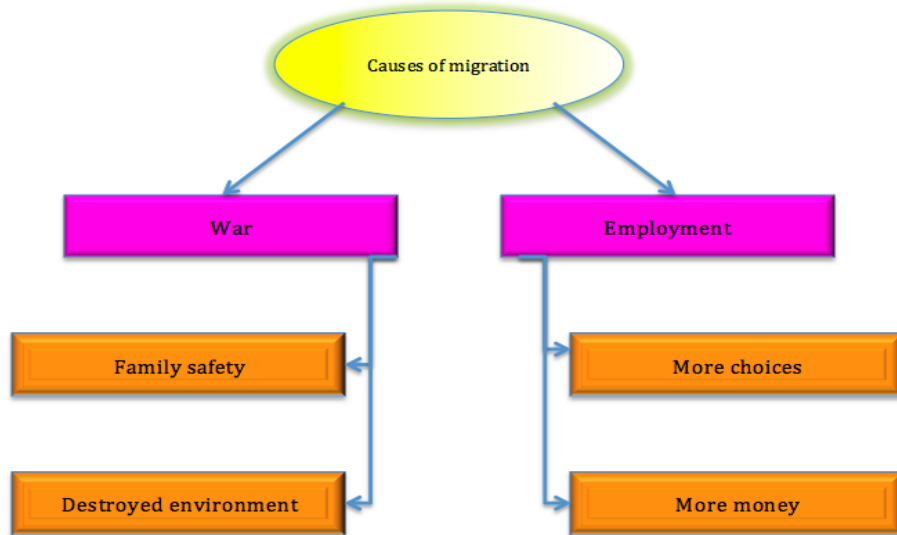


Unity: All the **supporting details** and **ideas** should be **related to** the topic sentence, the **main idea** of the paragraph.

Exercise

A) Analyze the mind map about the causes of migration. Read the following paragraph and develop the second supporting idea with your own facts, details or examples.

The prompt: "What are the causes of migration?"



BODY 1:

Unfortunately, devastating wars are a common occurrence causing large groups of people to emigrate. Wars create an unsafe environment for people and many families emigrate to escape the danger. Recently the war in Syria has caused a large number of families to move to Turkey. These refugees did not want to leave their homes but the dangerous fighting has forced them to move to a safe place where they are protected from the devastation. The war in Syria is just one example of people migrating for safety, unfortunately there are, and have been many other situations like this. Furthermore, wars destroy the natural environment. _____

_____. People who rely on the environment for their way of life are forced to leave these areas. They must migrate to new areas of the world where they can continue their existence.

B) Now, develop the supporting ideas for the second body.

1. EMPLOYMENT

2. MORE CHOICE

a. Develop it by providing reason/detail/fact/example

b. Link this explanation to the topic sentence / recap

3. MORE MONEY

a. Develop it by providing reason/detail/fact/example

b. Link this explanation to the topic sentence / recap

3.



LANGUAGE TIPS

Hedging: Academic writing tends to be cautious. Researchers are very aware that what we know today is only a partial truth, and that much of what we learn today will be modified or may even be completely disproven at some time in the future. Compare these two sentences:

GM foods are dangerous, as some research concluded that there are long-term risks.

GM foods may be dangerous, but long-term research in this field is unavailable.

The first sentence is too confident for an academic context; the second is more cautious because it accepts that we don't know the definite answer to this question. We often refer to the language used to express caution as *hedging*. Common examples of hedging are:

*The research **suggests** that...*

*There **seems to** be a link between...*

*There **may** be concerns about future developments...*

*It **appears** that...*

*There **may well** be...*

Exercise

Rewrite the following sentences using hedging language to make them more cautious.

1. The cloud will change the weather patterns.

There may well be a change in weather patterns if the cloud is introduced.

2. The machine will use too much CO₂ in the building process.

_____.

3. The project to encourage sea life will create problems with international law.

_____.

4. Building CO₂ storage plants will be too expensive.

_____.

5. There will be problems with releasing the CO₂ back into the atmosphere.

_____.

4. STRUCTURE & VOCABULARY AIDS FOR CAUSE/EFFECT ESSAYS

Using indicators

To express a cause and effect relationship we need to use some indicators. Indicators are signal words that connect the cause/reason to the effect/result. These indicators give a piece of writing its flow, and enable the reader to guess what comes next.

Signal Words for cause	Signal Words for effect
Because / Since / As Because of Due to Owing to As a consequence of As a result of On account of	So / Therefore / Thus / Hence Because of this For this reason, That's why, As a consequence, Consequently, Accordingly, As a result

Here is how you would use some signal words or CONNECTORS to form a cause-effect relationship to support your arguments.

A. The demand has increased. $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{As a consequence,} \\ \text{Accordingly,} \\ \text{Consequently,} \\ \text{Thus,} \\ \text{Hence,} \\ \text{Because of this,} \\ \text{Therefore,} \\ \text{As a result,} \end{array} \right\}$ the prices are high.

B. $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{Because} \\ \text{As} \\ \text{Since} \end{array} \right\}$ the demand has increased, the prices are higher.

C. Higher prices are $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{because of} \\ \text{due to} \\ \text{(as) a result of} \\ \text{on account of} \\ \text{owing to} \\ \text{a consequence of} \end{array} \right\}$ an increase in demand.

D. The prices are high $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{owing to the fact that} \\ \text{due to the fact that} \\ \text{because of the fact that} \\ \text{on account of the fact that} \end{array} \right\}$ there is an increase in demand.
(S+V+O)

VERBS: Look carefully at the signal words and verb phrases for the *cause and effect* structures shown below.

A. The $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{cause of} \\ \text{reason for} \end{array} \right\}$ higher prices was an increase in demand.
CAUSE

B. The $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{effect} \\ \text{consequence} \end{array} \right\}$ of an increase in demand is high prices.
EFFECT

C. An increase in demand $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{causes} \\ \text{results in} \\ \text{leads to} \\ \text{produces} \\ \text{brings about} \\ \text{gives rise to} \end{array} \right\}$ higher prices.
CAUSE **EFFECT**

D. Higher prices $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{result from} \\ \text{stem from} \\ \text{are caused by} \\ \text{derive from} \end{array} \right\}$ an increase in demand
EFFECT **CAUSE**

E. When $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{there is an increase in demand,} \\ \text{CAUSE} \end{array} \right\}$ (then) prices rise.
 If **EFFECT**

F. Other Verbs

An increase in demands **affects** prices.

(As the verb “affect” is neutral in meaning, an adjective like ‘higher’ before the word ‘prices’ is redundant.)

A constant fluctuation in prices **poses a threat to** the economy of a country.

(The verb phrase “pose a threat” has a negative connotation.)

Exercises

1. Fill in the blanks with one of the connectives.

due to	as	as a result	thus	on account of	since
for this reason		therefore	because		consequently

- Schools for girls were built. _____, girls had a chance to learn about health and life skills.
- _____ girls learned about health skills, they improved the sanitation of their villages.
- Girls were given school uniforms _____ they needed to feel that they were a valued part of the school.
- The girls felt proud to have a uniform. _____, they were more likely to attend school every day.
- The family members of the girls walked them to school _____ they didn't want other males in the village to taunt the girls.
- After graduation, the girls were more likely to start small businesses _____ their mathematical and accounting skills.
- Some graduates became valued business owners. _____, they were invited to serve on business councils.
- _____ their community status, they were able to vote on improving water and sanitation.
- Health conditions improved in villages. _____, more babies and children survived.

2. Look at the chart and match the phrases in the two columns. Then identify which phrases are the causes and which phrases are the effects of a situation. Put them into sentences using the verbs in parenthesis.

1. Smoking (cause)	A sense of responsibility and a feeling of compassion
2. A wide range of job opportunities	Cultural differences
3. Caring for animals	Premature aging (effect)
4. Misunderstandings	Poor management
5. A desire for attention	Networking
6. Unemployment	Bullying behavior
7. Business failure	An increase in crime rates

- _____ (result in)
- _____ (lead to)
- _____ (bring about)

4. _____ (result from)
5. _____ (to be caused by)
6. _____ (give rise to)
7. _____ (stem from)

3. Rewrite the following sentences using the cause and effect linkers in parenthesis.

1. He has a busy schedule; **therefore**, he won't be able to see us until Friday. (Due to)

2. **One consequence of** unemployment is the increase in crime rates. (bring about)

3. Being innovative in business **results in** gaining more customers. (Lead to)

4. In America, many banks went bankrupt **as a consequence of** the economic crisis. (result of)

5. **As** a lot of well-known companies require at least three years of work experience, graduates from university start their careers in small companies. (Consequently,)

6. Poor cultural literacy levels can **stem from** too much technology. (result in)

7. Not finding time to relax is **a cause of** the fast pace of life nowadays. (because of)

4. Combine the prompts given below using cause/effect linkers. Use a different linker in each sentence.

- | | |
|--|--|
| 1. cause: being a member of a social club | effect: taking more responsibilities |
| 2. cause: cultural differences | effect: communication breakdown |
| 3. cause: financial problems | effect: unhappy marriage |
| 4. cause: lack of study skills | effect: failure at school exams |
| 5. cause: use of technology in class | effect: variety of activities and materials |
| 6. cause: being workaholic | effect: variety of activities and materials |
| 7. cause: consuming fattening food | effect: gaining weight |

5. Error Correction: Find if the sentences are correct or incorrect by focusing on the meaning. Write 'C' if correct and 'I' if incorrect.

_I_1. Example: Because workers are under so much pressure to produce results in a higher level of stress.

_C_2. Example: Another related cause of stress is the need to earn money to survive in our more and more commercial world.

___3. Applying different methods of communication results in a better society.

___4. Being multilingual causes having parents speaking different languages.

___5. A damage in relationships gives rise to overuse of social media.

___6. Demolishing old houses to build modern ones has led to high concerns by preservationists.

___7. Having a part time job as a student can be caused by poor academic scores.

___8. Human workforce poses a threat to advances in the field of artificial intelligence.

___9. Oppositions to same sex marriages derive mostly from a conventional way of thinking.

___10. Having educated parents affects the upbringing of children in a positive way.

6. Complete the blanks either with a verb or a connective.

There is no doubt that we have to live with far more noise than in the past, particularly in cities and this may be the form of pollution which affects us directly. For example, it has been found that prolonged exposure to high levels of noise can 1 _____ hearing loss and high blood pressure. It may also 2 _____ stress, insomnia and mental problems, including depression. These problems, in return, often 3 _____ lower productivity at work. 4 _____ employees are too tired and stressed to work efficiently. In order to find effective solutions to the problem, it is necessary to understand what has 5 _____ this increase in noise. There are 3 main reasons why there has been an increase in noise. Firstly, there is traffic noise, which is 6 _____ the ever-increasing number of vehicles on our roads. The second major source of noise in our cities is low-flying aircraft which have either just taken off or are just landing at local airports. Finally, noise can also 7 _____ neighbors listening to music or watching television or using noisy power tools such as drills or lawn movers. To sum up, measures should be taken to reduce the amount of the noise in our daily lives.

[*Check Appendix 4 (Connectives) for a table of useful connectives.]

SAMPLE ESSAYS AND ESSAY WRITING PRACTICE

Prompt: "What positive effects has the computer had on our lives?"

Sample Essay 1

The twenty-first century has already turned out to be the century of the computer. The computer revolution that started after the Second World War is now developing more quickly and computers are beginning to influence and take over nearly every aspect of our lives. Computers are clearly changing and affecting society in many ways. ***The two main effects computers have had on our lives are in the areas of economics and communications.***

The computer has led to big changes in business life. To start with, businesses now have to be computerized or they risk failure. Every big corporation bases its operations on computing regardless of which sector they are in. For instance, many big companies market and sell different products and services, yet they all share one basic property, which is the fact that their operations would collapse without computers. ***Furthermore,*** computing is a generator of economic dynamism. More advanced economies are moving from an industrial-based economy to a computer and IT-based one. Similarly, China and India and many other developing countries have large IT sectors which drive their economies upwards. ***In short, the effects of computers on business life cannot be underestimated.***

The other important effect of the computer is that communication has been totally revolutionized. First and foremost, e-mailing has become a way of communication. In the past, people wrote letters, which would often take weeks to reach their destinations, or speak on the phone, which was terribly expensive. Now they send e-mails. Instead of waiting weeks for a letter, people can read e-mails instantly. ***Moreover,*** many people use computers to communicate with people all around the world using chat rooms and chat programs, this was impossible before computers have become widespread. ***To sum up, now people who live thousands of kilometers away from each other can communicate as much as they want and whenever they want using e-mail or chat rooms.***

In conclusion, computers have had a profound effect on life in many ways and it is in business and communication that they have had the greatest influence. In the future, if the computer continues evolving at such speed, our business practices and methods of communication will undergo even greater changes.

Adapted from: www.eslfow.com

Word Count: 354

Prompt: "What are the negative effects of terrorism?"

Sample Essay 2

It is known that terrorism is the act of violence against governments or society to get them to accept certain demands. The number of terrorist attacks has been on the rise for some time, which makes people think about the negative effects of it on people all over the world. ***The two main negative effects of terrorism are the failure in the social order and the collapse of economy of the country.***

The first and the most remarkable negative effect of terrorism is social disorder. First and foremost, people feel in danger when terrorist attacks happen where they live, which leads to fear and worry among people. Consequently, they don't trust anybody in the society and this brings about damage to societal bonds. Therefore, eventually the society collapses. ***Furthermore,*** especially people thinking that their children will face adversities due to terrorism want to leave their country so that they can provide their kids with a peaceful and protected place to live. As a result, nobody wants to be a part of the society and society concept is damaged. ***In brief, social disorder occurs when people and society are influenced by terrorist attacks.***

The other devastating drawback of terrorism is on the country's economy. To begin with, more money is spent on the military due to the fact that governments need to protect their citizens and fight terrorism. Thus, governments increase the amount of taxes and citizens get poorer, which brings about the crisis in economy. ***In addition,*** terrorism affects the economy of a country in terms of tourism. To elaborate, nobody wants to travel to places that are under attack because they are scared that they might lose their lives. Especially countries whose income is based on tourism are affected dramatically. ***In short, the impact of terrorism on the economies of countries is damaging.***

Taking everything in consideration, the failure in the society order and the collapse of economy of the country are the two main negative effects of terrorism. I personally hope that one day everybody will live in a peaceful, safe and protected environment without terrorism and that people won't have to bear any hardships resulting from this menace.

Word Count: 362

Prompt: "What are the negative effects of overpopulated cities?"

Sample Essay 3

People used to live in villages 50 years ago, but now more people live in cities. Cities get more and more crowded with a diversity of problems. Overpopulation in cities is a phenomenon affecting many countries in the world. It is largely caused by the migration of people searching for new opportunities that rural areas cannot provide. Though there exist some benefits in having large concentrations of people in an urban area, there are many negative outcomes. ***Two such outcomes of overpopulated cities are an increase in both health problems and crime rates.***

A unique set of health problems occurs in overpopulated cities that would not usually happen. To begin, overcrowding in cities increases the level of air and water pollution. Due to the large numbers of people driving cars and the industry created to support them the quality of air is reduced. Toxic gases and particles in the air can cause serious health problems such as lung diseases, asthma and other such breathing problems. Also, the fresh water supply of many cities can become contaminated due to the amount of people using the water. This contaminated water can carry many harmful bacteria and diseases, which may affect the health of the population. ***Moreover,*** with so many people living so close together, contagious diseases such as influenza can spread rapidly amongst the population. Crowded buses and other public transport systems are full of people standing or sitting extremely close to one another, so contagious diseases can easily be passed from one passenger to another. ***Consequently, overpopulation creates a serious health risk in many cities.***

Although crime is present in many cities, it is particularly prevalent in overcrowded urban areas. First of all, in most cases there are not enough jobs in an overpopulated city to support everyone. Many people move to cities from poor areas in order to find a substantial income to support their families or lifestyle. However, due to overcrowding these migrants are unable to find legitimate work, they still need an income and will often turn to a life of crime to support their lifestyles. There are many publications, which show the correlation between unemployment and crime rate. ***In addition,*** many people in overpopulated cities seek protection and assistance in the form of illegal gangs. These gangs are generally involved in crime. The gangs of Los Angeles are a famous example. They recruit young members who cannot find a legal income and need protection from other violent groups in the area. Although gangs are not restricted to overpopulated cities they can often go unchecked and are usually most successful in them. ***In short, overpopulation contributes to increase in crime rates in cities.***

Taking everything in to consideration, it can be observed that serious diseases and increased crime are some very serious negatives effects of overcrowding in cities. Poor air and water quality as well as the spread of disease makes these cities a health hazard. Also, overpopulated cities have alarming criminal issues due to unemployment and the formation of illegal gangs. Ultimately, as populations grow, these problems are going to increase. I believe governments need to step in and create some legislation to stop the overcrowding of cities.

Word count: 527

Prompt: “What are the positive effects of SMS Text Messaging on teenagers?”

Sample Essay 4

The increasing and widespread use of texting is revolutionizing communication in today's society. Young people are the driving force behind this growing text messaging culture. In Britain, 90% of teenagers claimed to text more than they talk on their phones. There is obviously some impact of this much texting on social interaction and on the development and maintenance of these relationships. ***The most common effects of texting on teenagers are that texting facilitates closer relationships and it helps people be a part of a social circle.***

The first of the positive effects of texting is better developed personal relationships. To begin with, texting affords a distinctive medium for personal contact. The fact that some people prefer texting to talking suggests that they get something out of texting that they cannot get from talking. As a result, they commit more time and effort to the process of message composition, expressing things in their messages they may not have felt comfortable saying face-to-face. ***Additionally,*** texters also texted significantly more than talkers did, and it is possible that this greater frequency of contact facilitated a deeper, more intimate relationship. For example, according to a study, an average British teenager sends 53 text messages per day. If a teenager doesn't text, he or she makes around 15 phone calls, which means fewer contacts with their social network. ***All in all, the depth and the quantity of text messages help teenagers enhance their relationships.***

The second positive effect is the fact that texting offers a sense of belonging in a social group. ***To start with,*** it is common knowledge that owning cell-phones and texting is popular among young people. When a teenager follows the same trend texting their friends occasionally, he or she will feel in-group and can share the same experiences with their peers. The opposite situation may result in feelings of insecurity and social deprivation. ***Furthermore,*** the number of social activities that youth can be informed of via text messaging is not negligible. Many age-appropriate extra-curricular events are communicated through text-messages. A teenager can learn about these and make arrangements to join such activities with the help of such messaging, which will further help them form new relationships. ***In short, texting is a trend that the teenagers of our time cannot afford to live without.***

In summary, texting seems to facilitate personal relationships and reinforces group membership. Especially for people who tend to be socially anxious and lonely, texting may be a way to help create new relationships and develop existing ones. It seems to me that someday the mobile may become more a matter of identity than a simple communication tool.

Adapted from: Reid, D. & Reid, F. (2004). *Insights into the Social and Psychological Effects of SMS Text Messaging*.

Exercise

Write an essay on the reasons WHY WOMEN SHOULD CONTINUE WORKING AFTER MARRIAGE.

Use the outline given.

INTRODUCTION SENTENCE	General information about the situation / question
HOOK	
THESIS STATEMENT	
BODY 1	
TOPIC SENTENCE	<u>FINANCIAL ISSUES</u>
SUPPORTING DETAIL 1	* Stand on their own feet
EXAMPLE 1 EXAMPLE 2 (optional)	- Do not have to depend on their husband or another person for their needs (money). - Free to buy anything to buy → feel independent about financial issues
SUPPORTING DETAIL 2	* Contribute to family budget
EXAMPLE 1 EXAMPLE 2 (optional)	- help their husbands pay for the house costs such as electricity bill. - save money for investment → have better life conditions / may have more opportunity for free time activities such as travelling.
BODY 2	
TOPIC SENTENCE	<u>PERSONAL ISSUES</u>
SUPPORTING DETAIL 1	* develop their social skills
EXAMPLE 1 EXAMPLE 2 (optional)	- meet new people / make new friends from different cultures / share different ideas → broaden their horizons - prevent having a monotonous life → be happy and affect the other family members in a positive way → joy
SUPPORTING DETAIL 2	* Career development
EXAMPLE 1 EXAMPLE 2 (optional)	- gain self confidence - find a better job → be happy
CONCLUSION	Concluding Sentence (restatement of the thesis) → Summary of the support details → advice

WHY DO YOU THINK WOMEN SHOULD CONTINUE WORKING AFTER MARRIAGE?

This image shows a full page of white paper with horizontal blue or grey ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page, providing a template for handwriting practice or general writing. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the page.

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Exercise

You are going to write an essay on either **the causes of stress** or **the effects of stress**. First, you need to brainstorm and prepare an outline. Then, write an essay of 350 + words.

Step 1. Brainstorming

Topic: _____

Step 2. Outline

I. INTRODUCTION

Thesis Statement: _____

II. BODY PARAGRAPH I

Topic Sentence: _____

Support 1: _____

Support 2: _____

III. BODY PARAGRAPH II

Topic Sentence: _____

Support 1: _____

Support 2: _____

IV. CONCLUSION

Paraphrasing the Thesis Statement: _____

Summarize the body paragraphs: _____

Final Comment: _____

Step 3. Write an essay on the causes of stress or the effects of stress.

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

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